Unlike `get_object_vars()` we can now see the protected and private properties, and their values, but they've had their names changed. Private properties are prefixed with the class name (`exp` becomes `Clericexp`) and protected properties are prefixed with a * character (`gold` becomes `*gold`).

Reflection

The functions we've just looked at are very useful for introspection in a pinch. If you want to quickly figure out if an object possesses specific capabilities, then a single call to, say, `method_exists()` can usually get the job done. For cases where a more in-depth analysis of an object, class – or even individual methods or properties – PHP offers the `Reflection` API. This API consists of a variety of classes in the root namespace, all with a name beginning with `Reflection` – there's `ReflectionObject` (for introspecting objects), `ReflectionMethod` (for methods), even `ReflectionEnum` and `ReflectionFunction` (for enums and functions). Reflection is not specific to PHP, the term *reflective programming* refers to code that is able to inspect and even modify its own structure and behavior. You can find reflection used extensively in testing frameworks such as PHPUnit.

This sub-section of the chapter will serve as a quick introduction to reflection in PHP, and I highly recommend *PHP 8 Objects, Patterns, and Practice* (Matt Zandstra) for further reading (for both reflection and OOP in general). As always, let's kick the tires, starting with a slightly modified version of the `Cleric` class from the previous example…

```
class Cleric
{
    // ... level, exp, and gold properties as before
    final public function prayerOfHealing(): void
    {
        // fix stuff
    }
}
```

… which has an additional `final` modifier added to the `prayerOfHealing()` method. To inspect an entire class, we have the choice of instantiating a `new ReflectionClass` object or a `new ReflectionObject`, which do not differ in their interfaces (`ReflectionObject` extends `ReflectionClass`, in fact). The general rule is to choose the